

Global CO₂ Emissions

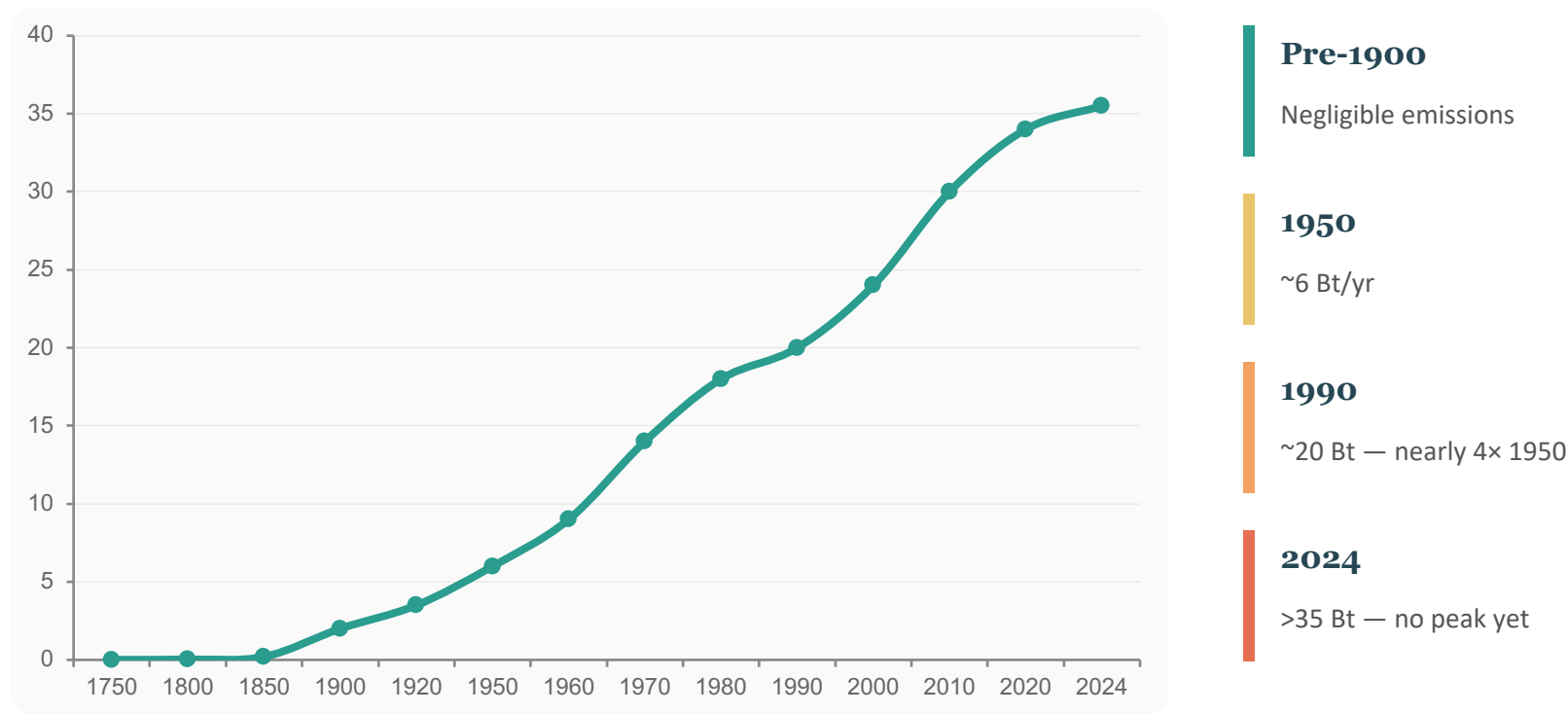
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil Fuels & Industry | 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

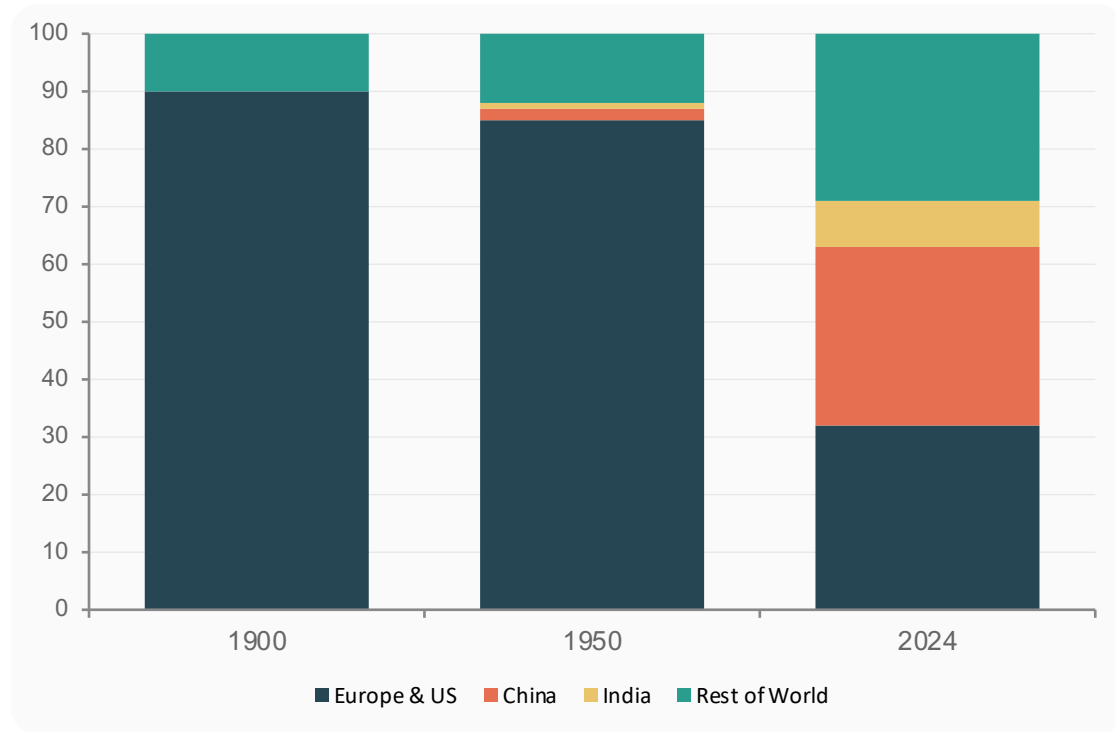
Hannah Ritchie & Max Roser

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



>90%

Europe & US share
in 1900

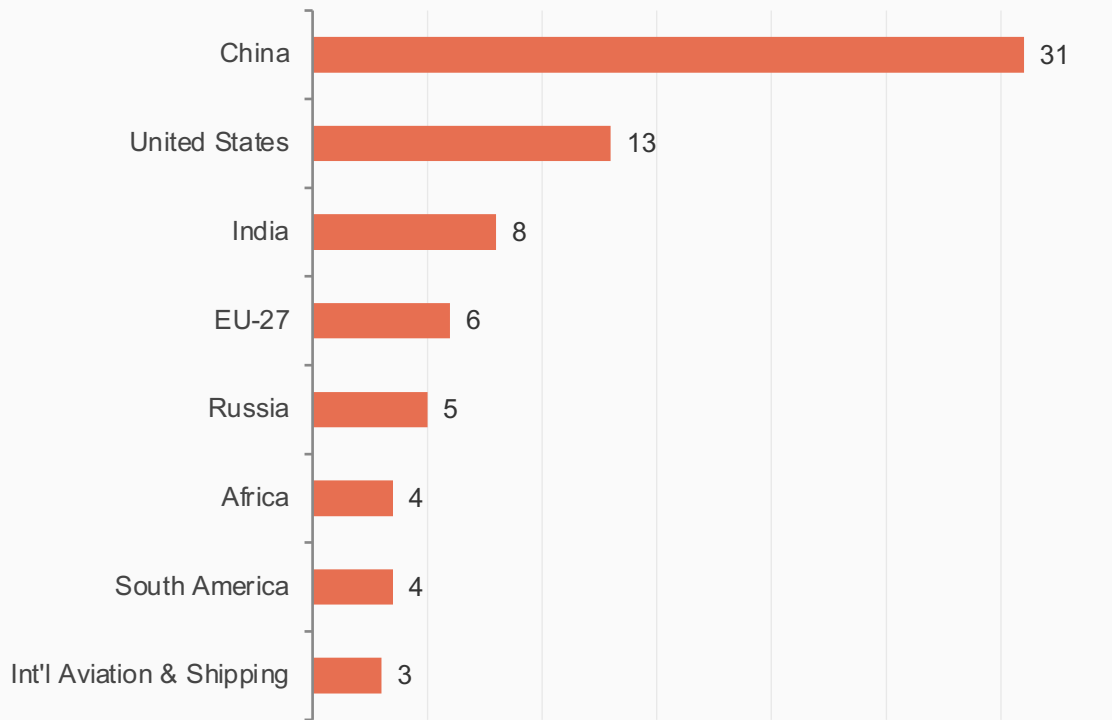
<1/3

Europe & US share
today

~50%

Asia's share today,
led by China

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



~31%

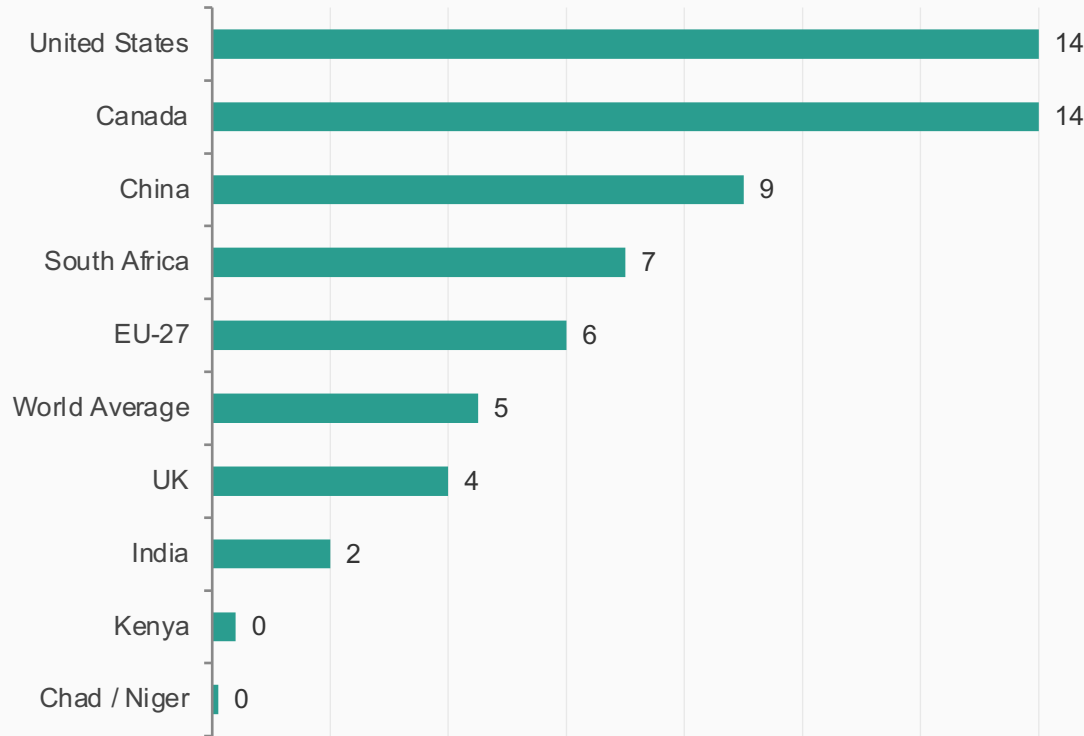
China's share of
global CO₂ in 2024

China: Rising, growth slowing

US: Declining

India: Rising

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



150×

gap between lowest
and highest emitters

An average American emits in under 2 days what a person in Mali or Niger emits in an entire year.

Per Capita Emissions: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

~14 t

United States

3× world average

~9 t

China

Largest total emitter
but below US per capita

~2 t

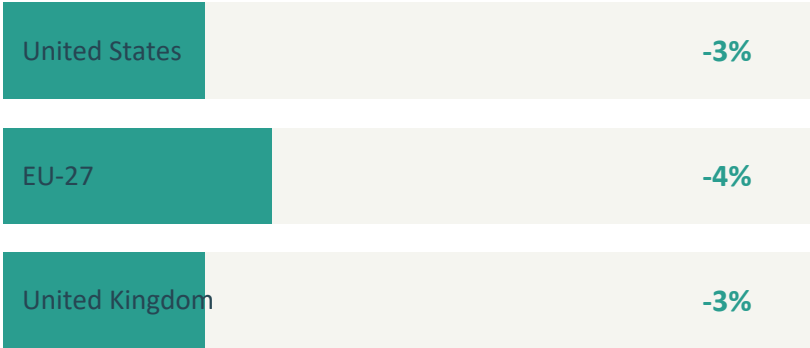
India

Below world average
despite 1.4B people

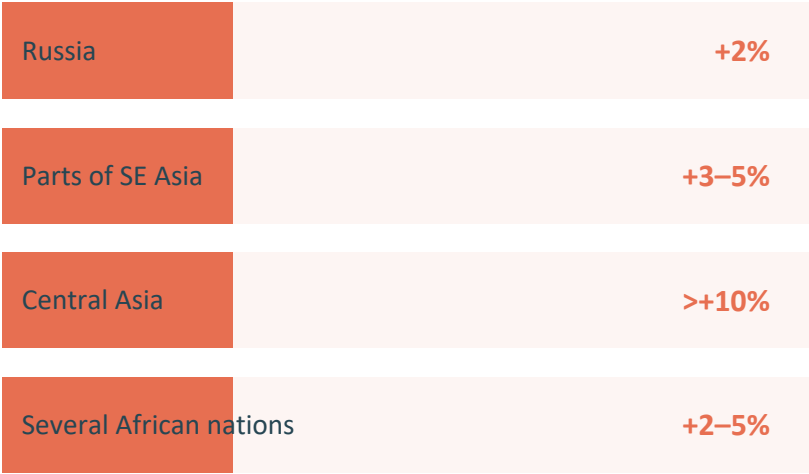
Country	Per Capita CO ₂ (approx. 2024)
Canada	~14 t
South Africa	~7 t
EU-27	~6 t
World Average	~4.5 t
United Kingdom	~4 t
Kenya	~0.4 t
Chad / Niger	~0.1 t

2024: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew

Emissions Declining

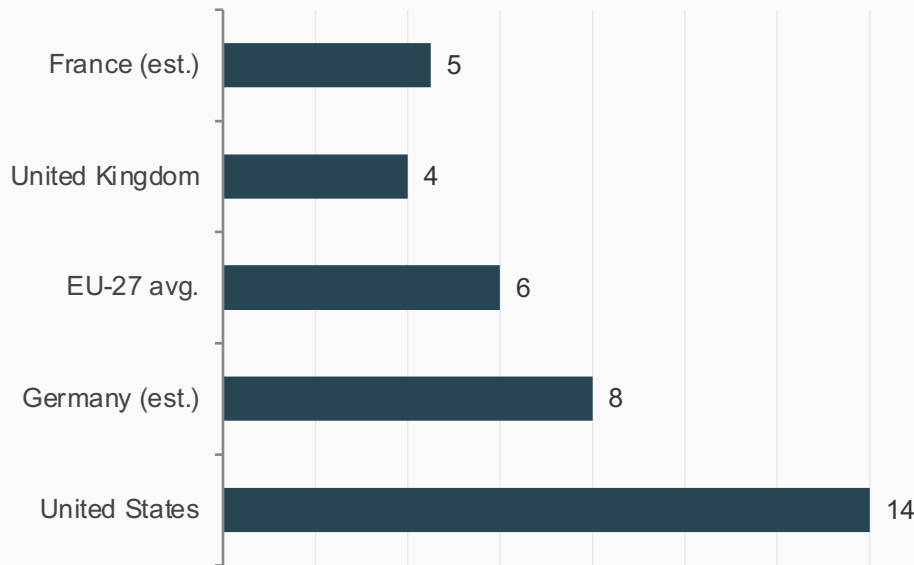


Emissions Growing



Mixed 2024 picture: developed-nation declines are partially offset by increases in parts of Asia, the Middle East, and Africa.

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Nuclear & Renewables

France, UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions because a higher share of their electricity comes from nuclear and renewable sources.

Fossil Fuel Dependence

Germany, the Netherlands, and the US have higher per capita emissions, driven by greater reliance on coal and natural gas for electricity.

Countries with similar prosperity levels can have very different per capita emissions depending on energy policy choices.

Key Takeaways

Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- 01** Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not yet peaked, despite slowing growth.
- 02** China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but its per capita emissions (~9 t) remain below the US (~14 t).
- 03** Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US, which accounted for >90% of emissions in 1900.
- 04** Per capita gaps of 150× persist between the richest (US/Canada at ~14 t) and poorest nations (Chad/Niger at ~0.1 t).
- 05** Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions — France and the UK prove this is possible.